

Scraping Murderpedia:

ARE MEN MORE LIKELY TO USE VIOLENT METHODS
WHEN COMMITTING HOMICIDE?

Lailaa Holmes

ECO 590

Motivation

1

Interested to see behavioral differences between male and female offenders, specifically in the methods used to commit homicide.

2

Men are responsible for most homicide offenses worldwide. Women are more likely to use less direct or less physically violent methods than men (UNODC).

Variables Collected

- **Name of offender**
- **Gender: male or female**
- **Method: shooting, poisoning, stabbing, etc.**
- **Number of victims**
- **Location**
- **Violent vs. non-violent method**
- **Serial killer status**

Web Scrapping Process

Murderpedia

The Encyclopedia of Murderers

Murderpedia is a free online encyclopedic dictionary of murderers and the largest database about serial killers and mass murderers around the world..

MALE murderers

5,852 entries - 1,573 photo galleries

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FEMALE murderers

1,069 entries - 661 photo galleries

[index by country](#) -
 [index by name](#)
[A](#)[B](#)[C](#)[D](#)[E](#)[F](#)[G](#)[H](#)[I](#)[J](#)[K](#)[L](#)[M](#)[N](#)[O](#)[P](#)[Q](#)[R](#)[S](#)[T](#)[U](#)[V](#)[W](#)[X](#)[Y](#)[Z](#)

Murderpedia has thousands of hours of work behind it. To keep creating new content, we kindly appreciate any donation you can give to help the Murderpedia project stay alive. We have many plans and enthusiasm to keep expanding and making Murderpedia a better site, but we really need your help for this. Thank you very much in advance.

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CRIMINALIA.ES

La enciclopedia del crimen
(in spanish)

Last updates **June 4, 2017**

DeathPenaltyUSA.org

The database of executions in the United States of America

Privacy Policy

```
male_url = "https://murderpedia.org/male.A/index.A.htm"
female_url = "https://murderpedia.org/female.A/index.A.htm"
male_response = requests.get(male_url, headers=headers)
female_response = requests.get(female_url, headers=headers)

male_soup = BeautifulSoup(male_response.text, "html.parser")
female_soup = BeautifulSoup(female_response.text, "html.parser")
male_response
female_response
```

[illegible]

New variable

VIOLENT VS
NONVIOLENT

```
[95]: #Next I am adding my orginial variable which is violent vs nonviolent
violent_methods = ["Shooting", "Stabbing", "Strangulation","Bludgeoning/Beating", "Axe/Hatchet","Drowning", "Burning/Fire"]

violent_vs_nonviolent = ["Non-violent" if m == "Poisoning"
                        else "Violent" if m in violent_methods
                        else "Unknown"
                        for m in final_df["method"]] #nonviolent equals poisoning
]
```

```
[96]: #Combing this with my previous variables
final_df["violent_vs_nonviolent"] = violent_vs_nonviolent
print(final_df[["name", "gender", "method", "violent_vs_nonviolent"]].head(270).to_string())
```

	name	gender	method	violent_vs_nonviolent
0	Abbas Baqir	Male	Shooting	Violent
1	ABBAS	Male	Shooting	Violent
2	Burton W. ABBOTT	Male	Poisoning	Non-violent
3	Jack Henry ABBOTT	Male	Stabbing	Violent
4	William Keith ABBOTT	Male	Shooting	Violent
5	Azad ABDULLAH	Male	Stabbing	Violent
6	Herisch Ali ABDULLAH	Male	Shooting	Violent
7	Ricky ABEYTA	Male	Shooting	Violent
8	Roderick ABEYTA	Male	Shooting	Violent
9	Nathaniel Jamal ABRAHAM	Male	Shooting	Violent
10	Myer ABRAMOVICH	Male	Stabbing	Violent
11	Elias	Male	Poisoning	Non-violent
12	ABUELAZAM	Male	Poisoning	Non-violent
13	Saber & Mahmoud ABU-EL-ULLA	Male	Shooting	Violent
14	Mumia ABU-JAMAL	Male	Poisoning	Non-violent
15	Ali Hassan ABU JAMAL	Male	Shooting	Violent
16	Elias ACEVEDO Sr.	Male	Shooting	Violent

New variable

SERIAL KILLER

```
#Lastly I will be creating my second variable which is if an offender is a serial killer or not.
#According to the FBI to be a serial killer you need to have 2 or more victims
import re #I used this library to extract numbers from the victim column because some victim counts included symbols or text such as: 5-18,several, or 2+

# Creating serial killer variable
final_df["serial_killer"] = [
    "Yes" if re.findall(r"\d+", str(v)) #finding the text and numbers (d= digits and + = one or more digits)
    and int(re.findall(r"\d+", str(v))[0]) >= 2 #converts the victim value into an integer and finds if an offender has more than one victim
    else "No"
    for v in final_df["victims"] #using to find the victims each person has
]

print(final_df[["name", "gender", "method","violent_vs_nonviolent","victims","serial_killer"] ].head(270).to_string())
```

	name	gender	method	violent_vs_nonviolent	victims	serial_killer
0	Burton W. ABBOTT	Male	Poisoning	Non-violent	1	No
1	Jack Henry ABBOTT	Male	Stabbing	Violent	2	Yes
2	William Keith ABBOTT	Male	Shooting	Violent	1	No
3	Azad ABDULLAH	Male	Stabbing	Violent	1	No
4	Herisch Ali ABDULLAH	Male	Shooting	Violent	1	No
5	Ricky ABEYTA	Male	Shooting	Violent	7	Yes
6	Roderick ABEYTA	Male	Shooting	Violent	1	No
7	Nathaniel Jamal ABRAHAM	Male	Shooting	Violent	1	No
8	Myer ABRAMOVICH	Male	Stabbing	Violent	2	Yes
9	Saber & Mahmoud ABU-EL-ULLA	Male	Shooting	Violent	13	Yes
10	Mumia ABU-JAMAL	Male	Poisoning	Non-violent	1	No
11	Ali Hassan ABU JAMAL	Male	Shooting	Violent	1	No
12	Elias ACEVEDO Sr.	Male	Shooting	Violent	2	Yes
13	Francisco ACEVEDO	Male	Strangulation	Violent	3	Yes
14	Daniel Clate ACKER	Male	Stabbing	Violent	1	No
15	Lorne Joe ACQUIN	Male	Stabbing	Violent	9	Yes
16	Robert James ACREMANT	Male	Shooting	Violent	3	Yes

Grouping

SERIAL
KILLER,
LOCATION, AND
GENDER

```
#Counting to see how many serial killers and non-serial killers there are by gender and location
final_df["usa_location"] = ["USA" if "USA" in str(x) else "Non-USA" for x in final_df["location"]]
serial_by_gender = (final_df.groupby( ["usa_location", "gender", "serial_killer"] )["name"].count().reset_index(name="count"))

print(serial_by_gender)
#Women regardless of location are not serial killers
#However for males there are more serial killers not in the US
```

	usa_location	gender	serial_killer	count
0	Non-USA	Female	No	15
1	Non-USA	Female	Yes	5
2	Non-USA	Male	No	23
3	Non-USA	Male	Yes	33
4	USA	Female	No	20
5	USA	Female	Yes	10
6	USA	Male	No	80
7	USA	Male	Yes	68

Grouping

VICTIM AVERAGE & TOTAL

```
#I want to find average number of victims for gender and also the total number
# First i need to covert victims to be numeric for the average
final_df["victims_num"] = pd.to_numeric(final_df["victims"], errors="coerce") #https://pandas.pydata.org/docs/reference/api/pandas.to_numeric.html

# Average number of victims by gender
average_victims = final_df.groupby("gender")["victims_num"].mean().reset_index()

print("Average Victims by Gender")
print(average_victims)

# Total number of victims by gender
total_victims = final_df.groupby("gender")["victims_num"].sum().reset_index()

print("Total Victims by Gender")
print(total_victims)

#From this information women are likley to have 3 victims while men have 4 and the number of victims from male offenders is significantly higher than females
```

```
Average Victims by Gender
  gender  victims_num
0  Female      2.869565
1   Male      3.922652
Total Victims by Gender
  gender  victims_num
0  Female      132.0
1   Male      710.0
```

Grouping

VICTIM,
METHOD, AND
LOCATION

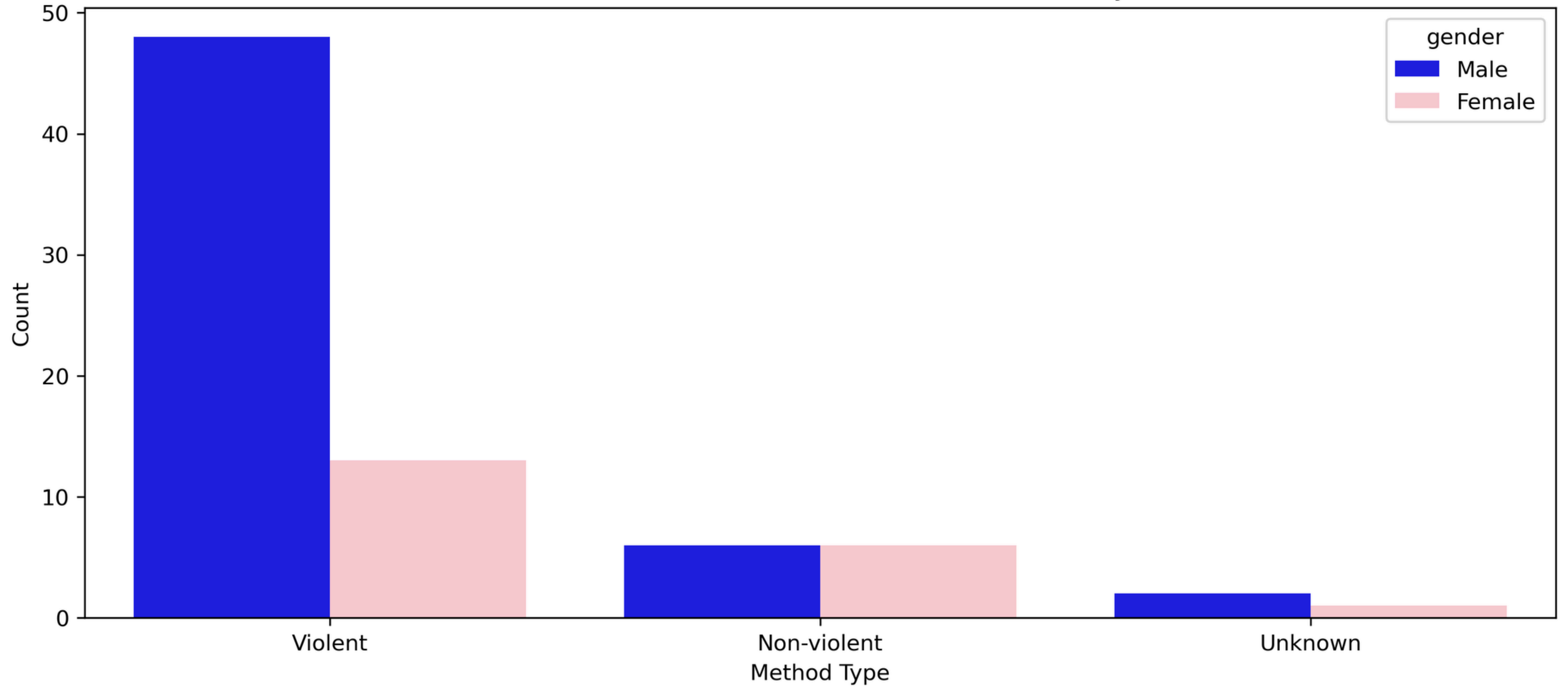
```
: #Grouping by location and gender and method to see if location impacts method
#But first I am going to make a USA variable since currently it shows up as states
final_df["usa_location"] = ["USA" if "USA" in str(x) else "Non-USA" for x in final_df["location"]]

# Grouping USA vs Non-USA by gender and method type
usa_gender_method = (final_df.groupby(["usa_location", "gender", "method"]).size().reset_index(name="count"))

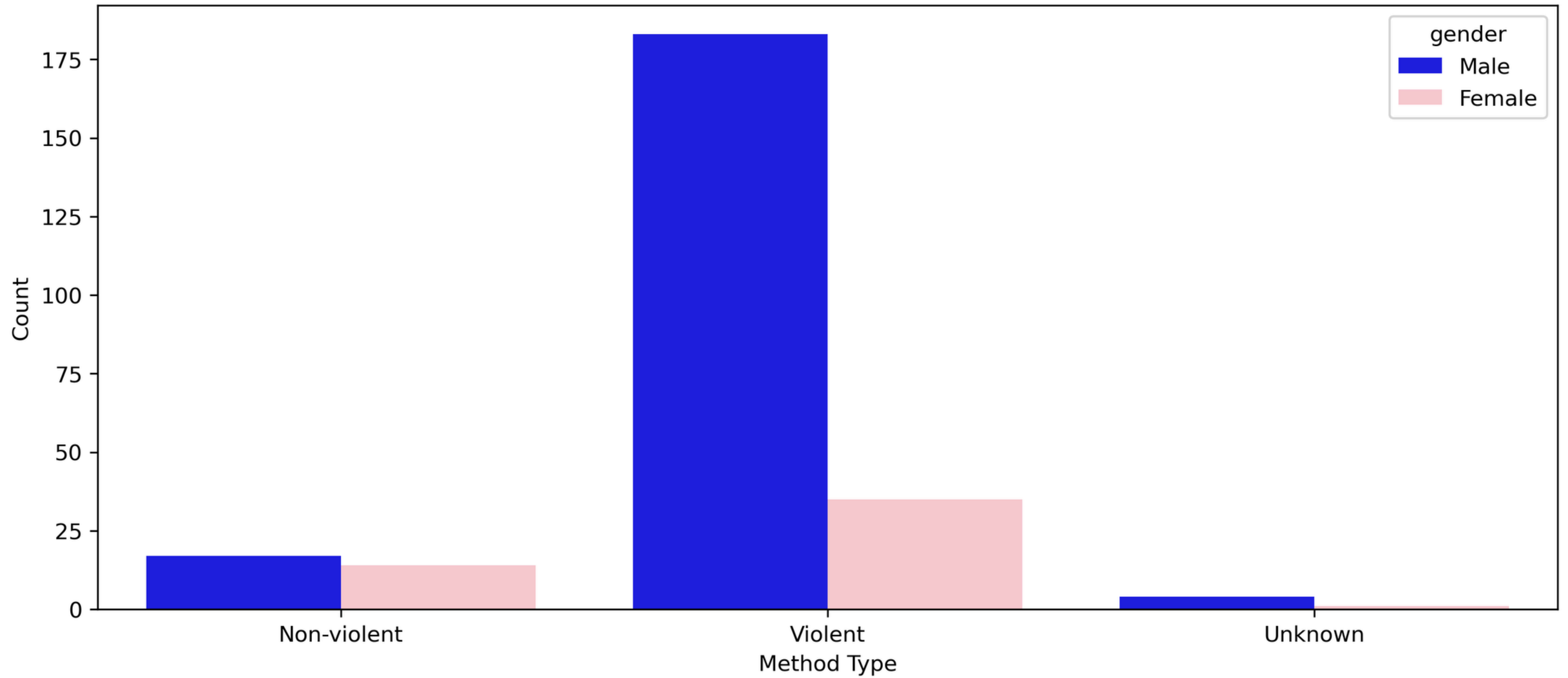
print(usa_gender_method)
#For women not in the US their main method is posion while in the US it is shooting
#For maless regardless of location shooting is their main method
```

	usa_location	gender	method	count
0	Non-USA	Female	Bludgeoning/Beating	4
1	Non-USA	Female	Burning/Fire	1
2	Non-USA	Female	Poisoning	6
3	Non-USA	Female	Shooting	3
4	Non-USA	Female	Stabbing	5
5	Non-USA	Female	Unknown	1
6	Non-USA	Male	Bludgeoning/Beating	6
7	Non-USA	Male	Poisoning	6
8	Non-USA	Male	Shooting	25
9	Non-USA	Male	Stabbing	11
10	Non-USA	Male	Strangulation	6
11	Non-USA	Male	Unknown	2
12	USA	Female	Bludgeoning/Beating	1
13	USA	Female	Poisoning	8
14	USA	Female	Shooting	13
15	USA	Female	Stabbing	6
16	USA	Female	Strangulation	2
17	USA	Male	Bludgeoning/Beating	5
18	USA	Male	Burning/Fire	1
19	USA	Male	Drowning	1
20	USA	Male	Poisoning	11
21	USA	Male	Shooting	95
22	USA	Male	Stabbing	28
23	USA	Male	Strangulation	5
24	USA	Male	Unknown	2

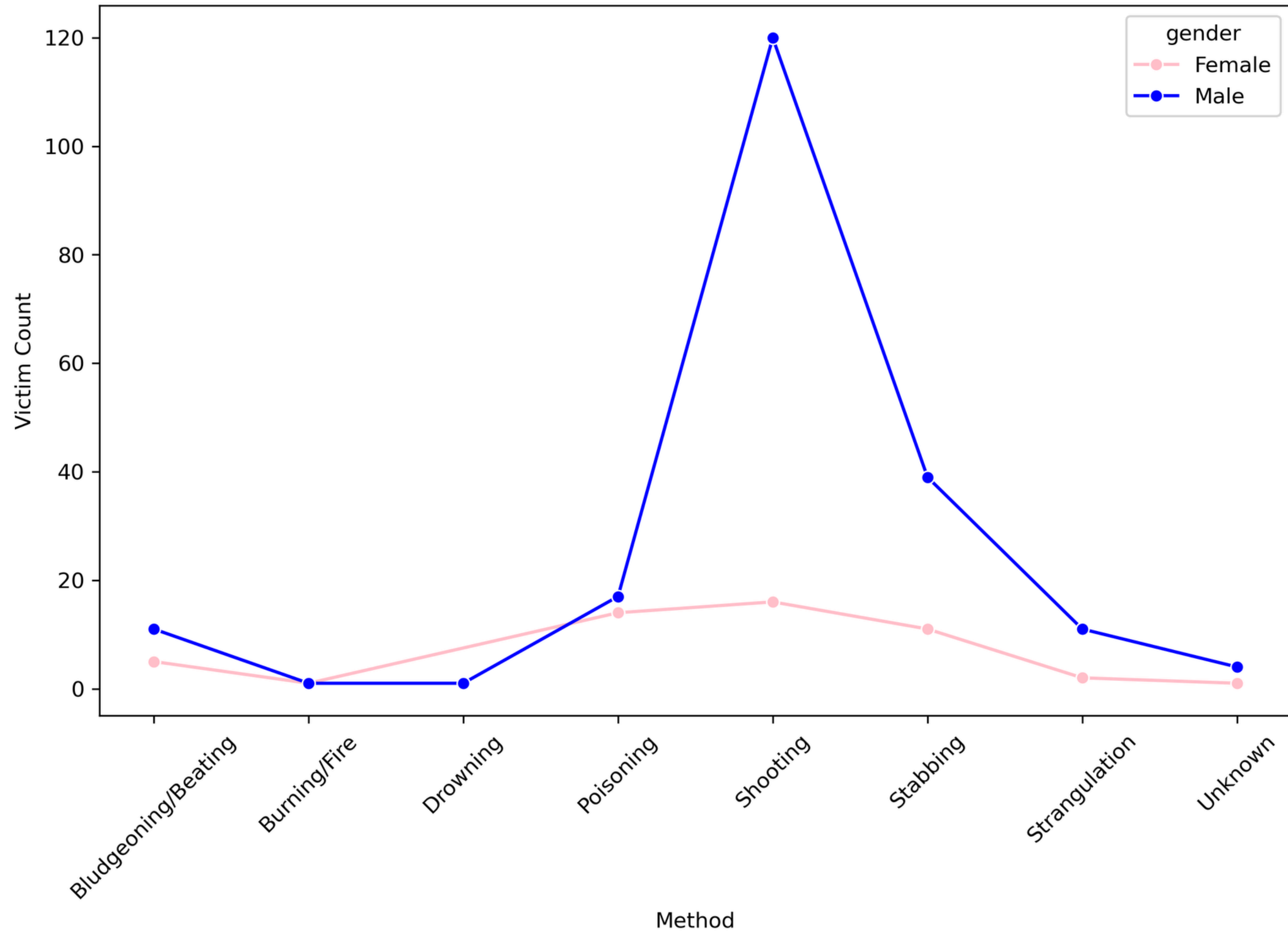
Non-USA Offenders: Violent vs Non-Violent Methods by Gender



USA Offenders: Violent vs Non-Violent Methods by Gender



Method of Killing by Gender



Regression Results			
	<i>Dependent variable:</i>		
	Violent (USA)	Violent (Serial Killer)	Shooting (AME)
	(1)	(2)	(3)
Male	0.207** (0.089)	0.205*** (0.068)	0.972*** (0.346)
Serial Killer		0.042 (0.106)	0.415 (0.269)
USA	0.083 (0.099)	0.060 (0.047)	0.962*** (0.293)
Male * USA	-0.028 (0.112)		
Male * Serial Killer		-0.047 (0.116)	
Constant	0.650*** (0.076)	0.651*** (0.064)	-1.507*** (0.388)
Observations	254	254	254
R ²	0.057	0.058	
Adjusted R ²	0.046	0.042	
Log Likelihood			-163.195
Akaike Inf. Crit.			334.390
Residual Std. Error	0.341 (df = 250)	0.342 (df = 249)	
F Statistic	5.051*** (df = 3; 250)	3.801*** (df = 4; 249)	
<i>Note:</i> *p<0.1; **p<0.05; ***p<0.01			

Thank you!